INCH-POUND

MIL-A-55680B(CR)
26 April 1991

SUPERSEDING
MIL-A-55680A(EL)
23 October 1970

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ANTENNA AT-1108( )/ARC

This specification is approved for use by the Communications-Electronics Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of communication airborne antenna which operates within the frequency ranges of the VHF Band from 116 to 152 MHz and UHF Band from 225 to 400 MHz and is designated Antenna AT-1108( )/ARC (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Communications-Electronics Command and Fort Monmouth, ATTN: AMSEL-ED-TM, Fort Monmouth, New Jersey 07703-5000 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 5821

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SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-11268	-	Parts, Materials, and Processes Used in Electronic Communication Equipment
MIL-M-13231	-	Marking of Electronic Items
MIL-F-14072	-	Finish for Ground Signal Equipment

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspections by Attributes
MIL-STD-252	-	Wired Equipment, Classification of Visual and Mechanical Defects
MIL-STD-454	-	Standard General Requirements for Electronic Equipment
MIL-STD-810	-	Environmental Test Methods

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg 4D, 700 Robbins Ave, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094).

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

COMMUNICATIONS-ELECTRONICS COMMAND

SC-D-459388	Antenna AT-1108( )/ARC

(Copies of drawings required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity).

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), samples shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.8) in accordance with 4.3.

3.1.1 Compatibility.

a. First time contractors shall complete independent Government bench and flight tests in addition to the first article tests. After successful

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completion of the first article tests in accordance with 3.1, six units representative of the production hardware are to be delivered to a facility designated by the procurement activity 90 days prior to shipment of the first month's production. These units will be subjected to independent Government laboratory and flight testing for a minimum of ten hours each. Technical personnel, special tools and test equipment shall be provided by the contractor, as required, for the duration of the Government bench tests and flight tests.

b. Upon successful completion of this testing, production deliveries of the configuration tested may begin. Upon refurbishment of test specimens, after having successfully passed the required Group A inspection, they may be delivered under the contract as part of the production requirements.

3.2 Performance. The antenna shall be subjected to and meet all the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Finish, protective. The equipment shall be finished in accordance with MIL-F-14072. This includes finish of hardware, such as screws, etc., and necessary touch-up after mounting. The final paint film on Type I surface shall be lusterless black epoxy Color No. 3725 in MIL-F-14072 (see 4.4).

3.4 Marking.

3.4.1 General. Marking shall conform to MIL-M-13231 (see 4.4).

3.4.2 Visibility. Wherever practicable, parts shall be so mounted that their identification markings will be readily visible with minimum disassembly of the equipment.

3.4.3 Serial numbers. The antennas on order shall be serial numbered as specified in the contract or purchase order.

3.5 Cleaning.

3.5.1 Parts. After fabrication, parts shall be cleaned to the extent that they are free from rust, scale, grease and other foreign material. Cleaning processes shall have no deleterious effect. Corrosive material shall be removed completely before the parts are mounted on chassis, panels, etc.

3.5.2 Units. After assembly, units shall be cleaned thoroughly and shall be free from particles of solder, flux and other foreign material. In addition, when necessary, such cleaning shall also be performed before final assembly of the units.

3.6 Form, fit. The antennas shall comply with SC-D-459388.

3.7 Physical construction. Physical construction of the equipment shall conform to SC-D-459388.

3.8 Connectors, input. The input connector for the VHF band shall be a BNC Female Type and the connector for the UHF band shall be a TNC Female Type connector as shown on SC-D-459388.

3.9 Tropicalization of materials.

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3.9.1 Treatment of materials. Fungus-inert materials shall be used where practicable. These materials shall be in accordance with requirement 4 of MIL-STD-454. When materials are required to be treated, they shall be cleaned in accordance with requirement 9 of MIL-STD-454 and then shall be treated in accordance with 3.10.2 through 3.10.4 and applicable paragraphs of MIL-P-11268. Overall treatment is not required. However, any parts and materials susceptible to moisture and fungus (or whose moisture-and-fungus resistance properties cannot be determined) that have not been treated before assembly shall be individually treated.

3.9.2 Treating compounds. Treating compounds containing a mercury-bearing fungicide shall not be used. The contractor shall determine that the treating compound is compatible with the material or surface to be treated. Selection of treating compounds shall be such that any increase in flammability of treated material will be held to the practical minimum.

3.9.3 Toxicity. Treating materials shall cause no skin irritation or other injury to personnel handling the treated material during fabrication, transportation, operation, or maintenance of the equipment, or during use of the finished items when used for the purpose intended.

3.9.4 Flexibility. Treatment shall not affect the flexibility of treated materials, to the extent that the equipment may fail to meet specified requirements when subjected to specified service conditions.

3.9.5 Statement of treatment. The statement of treatment shall indicate whether or not nutrient materials have been employed. If nutrient materials have been used, it shall also describe in detail the materials to be treated and the treating compounds and processes that the contractor proposes to use (see 6.2).

3.10 Service conditions. The unit(s) shall meet the service conditions specified in MIL-STD-810 except as otherwise specified herein (see 4.7).

3.10.1 Temperature-Altitude.

a. Operating. Continuous operation conforming to limits specified for natural conditions at altitudes up to 50,000 feet above sea level and at temperatures from -54° C to +55° C. Intermittent operation to +71° C (see 4.7.1).

b. Non-operating. At altitudes up to 50,000 feet above sea level at temperatures from -62° C to +85° C there shall be no deterioration (see 4.7.1).

3.10.2 Relative humidity. The unit(s) shall withstand 95% relative humidity when tested in accordance with 4.7.2.

3.10.3 Vibration. The unit(s) shall withstand vibration normally encountered in both fixed and rotary wing aircraft when tested in accordance with 4.7.3.

3.10.4 Rain. The units(s) shall meet the performance requirements of this document when subjected to rain as encountered in service (see 4.7.4).

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3.10.5 Sand and dust. The units(s) shall withstand exposure to sand and dust particles as encountered in desert areas (see 4.7.5).

3.10.6 Shock. The units(s) shall withstand the impact shock of 30g (see 4.7.6).

3.10.7 Acceleration. The units(s) shall withstand 6g steady state acceleration for one minute (see 4.7.7).

3.10.8 Salt fog. The units shall be exposed, in normal operating configuration to salt fog for 48 hours and shall show no evidence of corrosion as evidenced by any visible degradation that can be attributed to flaky, pitted, blistered or otherwise loosened finish (see 4.7.8).

3.11 Electrical requirements.

3.11.1 Impedance, input/output. The unit(s) shall have a nominal 50 ohm impedance over the frequency ranges of UHF Band from 116 to 152 MHz and UHF Band from 225 to 400 MHz as specified (see 4.8.1).

3.11.2 Voltage standing wave ratio (VSWR). The VSWR shall not exceed 3.0:1.0 over the frequency range of the VHF band from 116 to 152 MHz and the UHF band from 225 to 400 MHz when mounted on a 4 foot ground plane (see 4.8.2).

3.11.3 Omnidirectional pattern. The antenna pattern shall be within -3 dB of omnidirectional in azimuth plane (parallel to level flight of aircraft) and shall be within -5 dB of omnidirectional in azimuthal cuts of deflection from horizontal to a maximum deflection of 45 degrees (see 4.8.3).

3.11.4 Gain, antenna. Utilizing a reference 0.5 wave dipole, the gain of the antenna shall be a minimum of -6 dB (see 4.8.4).

3.11.5 Isolation, bands. The isolation between the bands as measured between the connectors shall be not less than 40 dB (see 4.8.5).

3.11.6 Power input, rf. There shall be no degradation of VSWR readings greater than 0.1 unit after the equipment is subjected to 50 watts of RF power. The VSWR maximum of 3.0:1.0 shall still apply (see 4.8.6).

3.12 Operational inspection. Each unit shall be capable of meeting the specified test after applicable processes, inspections and tests have been completed to determine that each unit on order is operable prior to packaging (see 4.11).

3.13 Interchangeability. Like units, and replaceable parts shall be physically and functionally interchangeable, without modification of such items or of the equipment. Individual items shall not be hand picked for fit or performance; however, matched pairs or sets, when permitted, may be interchangeable as such. Reliance shall not be placed on any unspecified dimension rating, characteristic, etc (see 4.10).

3.14 Technical literature. Technical literature shall be furnished if specified in the contract (see 6.2).

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3.15 Workmanship. The unit(s) shall be manufactured and assembled in accordance with Requirement 9 of MIL-STD-454 and the following paragraphs herein:

Cleaning	3.5
Tropicalization of materials	3.9

3.16 System Safety Engineering

3.16.1 Personnel hazards. Personnel hazards shall be kept to a minimum. The criteria of MIL-STD-454, Requirements 1 and 8 shall be made applicable for tasks and efforts such as the selection of parts, the complete manufacturing and assembly process, and any product baseline configuration changes that may be implemented during the course of the contract. Verification that compliance with this requirement has been achieved shall be through a visual inspection.

3.16.2 Edge rounding exposed. Exposed edges shall be rounded to a minimum radius of 0.04 inch (1 mm), and exposed corners to a minimum of 0.5 inch (13 mm).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements; however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspection. Inspection shall be classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Inspection covered by subsidiary documents (see 4.4).

c. Quality conformance inspection of items before packaging (see 4.5).

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4.3 First article inspection. This inspection will be performed by the contractor unless otherwise specified in the contract. It shall consist of the inspection specified in the subsidiary documents covering the items listed in 4.4, and the inspection specified for Group A, Group B, and Group C (see Tables I, II, and III respectively). The preproduction inspection will normally be performed in this order: (1) vibration, (2) shock; other preproduction inspection may precede, follow, or be interspersed between the foregoing.

4.4 Inspection covered by subsidiary documents. The following shall be inspected under the applicable subsidiary documents as part of the inspection of the units before preparation for delivery:

Item	Where Required
Finish Protective	3.3
Marking	3.4
Form, Fit	3.6

4.5 Quality conformance inspection of equipment before packaging. The contractor shall perform the inspection specified in 4.4 and 4.5.1 through 4.5.4. This does not relieve the contractor of his responsibility for performance of any additional inspection which is necessary to control the quality of the product and to assure compliance with all specification requirements. The Government will review and evaluate the contractor's inspection procedures and examine the contractor's inspection records. In addition, the Government, at its discretion, may perform all or any part of the specified inspection, to verify the contractor's compliance with specified requirements (see 6.9). Test equipment for Government verification inspection shall be made available by the contractor.

4.5.1 Group A inspection. Each unit of each lot of equipment shall be inspected for conformance to all the inspection and test requirements of Table I. Group A inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government, except that the operational inspection 4.11 shall be last (see 6.8).

TABLE I. Group A inspection.

Inspection of Test	Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Paragraph
Visual and Mechanical	3.15	4.9
Antenna (less cover)		
Antenna AT-1108()/ARC		
Electrical		
Voltage Standing Wave Ratio (VSWR)	3.11.2	4.8.2
Power, Input RF	3.11.6	4.8.6
Operational Inspection	3.12	4.11

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4.5.2 Group B inspection. This inspection, including sampling, shall conform to Table II. The Group B inspection shall normally be performed on inspection lots that have passed Group A inspection and on samples selected from units that have met the Group A inspection. The Sample size shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

TABLE II. Group B inspection.

Inspection of Test	Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Paragraph
Impedance, Input/ Output	3.11.1	4.8.1
Isolation, Bands	3.11.5	4.8.5
Interchangeability	3.13	4.10

4.5.3 Group C inspection. This inspection shall be as listed in Table III and shall normally be performed on sample units that have been subjected to and met Group A and Group B inspection. No defects shall be allowed. Sample unit(s) shall be selected in accordance with 4.5.3.1.

4.5.3.1 Sampling for inspection of equipment. Units selected for each Group C inspection shall be selected without regard to their quality in accordance with the following:

TABLE III. Group C inspection.

Inspection of Test	Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Paragraph
Subgroup I:		
Temperature-Altitude	3.10.1	4.7.1
Relative Humidity	3.10.2	4.7.2
Vibration	3.10.3	4.7.3
Omnidirectional Pattern	3.11.3	4.8.3
Gain, Antenna	3.11.4	4.8.4
Subgroup II:		
Rain	3.10.4	4.7.4
Sand and Dust	3.10.5	4.7.5
Shock	3.10.6	4.7.6
Acceleration	3.10.7	4.7.7
Salt Fog	3.10.8	4.7.8

4.5.3.1.1 Subgroup I. For this subgroup, two units from the first 25 production units shall be selected for the first Group C inspection. For subsequent Group C inspection, two units each month shall be selected.

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4.5.3.1.2 Subgroup II. For this subgroup, two units from the first 25 production units shall be selected for the first Group C inspection. For subsequent Group C inspection, two units every two months shall be selected.

4.5.3.2 Noncompliance. The contractor shall immediately report in writing each Group C failure occurrence, including details of the failure and characteristics affected. The contractor shall immediately investigate the cause of failure and further report the results of investigation and details of the proposed corrective action on (i) the process and materials, as applicable, and (ii) all units of product which were manufactured under the same conditions and which the Government considers subject to the same failure. Reports shall be forwarded to the responsible technical activity designated in the contract through the Product Assurance Representative. After corrective action has been taken, additional sample units shall be subjected to Group C inspection (all inspections, or the inspections which the sample failed, at the option of the Government) and Group A and B inspection may be reinstituted; however, final acceptance and shipment will be withheld until the Group C reinspection results have shown that the corrective action was effective (see 6.5).

4.5.4 Reinspection of conforming Group C sample units. Unless otherwise specified, sample units which have been subjected to and pass Group C inspection may be delivered on the contract or order, provided all damage is repaired, the sample units are cleaned of all foreign matter, and the sample units are resubjected to and pass Group A inspection.

4.6 Standard test conditions. The following test condition shall apply when specified herein:

a. Ground plane:

(1) Material: Aluminum

(2) Thickness: 1/8 inch minimum

(3) Round

(a) Diameter: 4 feet

(b) Reinforced on back side if required

b. Impedance: 50 ohms nominal

c. Free space: Minimum distance to nearest object 25 feet

d. Test frequencies: The frequencies utilized shall be spaced at least every 5 MHz in the VHF band and at least every 15 MHz in the UHF band, and shall include the end points of each band.

4.7 Service conditions. The unit(s) shall be subjected to and meet the service conditions in accordance with MIL-STD-810, unless otherwise specified. The electrical test of 4.8.2 (VSWR) shall be conducted prior to and subsequent to each service condition that requires a test to be conducted. The measurement in this test shall not change more than five (5) percent from the value measured prior to subjection to the test condition.

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4.7.1 Temperature-altitude. The unit(s) shall be subjected to Method 520.1 of MIL-STD-810 for compliance with I-3.2.3.2 (see 3.10.1). Any type of chamber of adequate size to hold the specified ground plane will suffice for this test since only possible changes in the VSWR are sought. A pretest VSWR is to be made to obtain a chamber reference VSWR.

4.7.2 Relative humidity. The unit(s) shall be subjected to Method 507.3, Procedure II, MIL-STD-810 for compliance with 3.10.2.

4.7.3 Vibration test. The unit(s) shall be subjected to Method 514.4, Procedure I, MIL-STD-810 for compliance with 3.10.3.

4.7.4 Rain. The unit(s) shall be tested in accordance with Method 506.3, Procedure I, MIL-STD-810. The antenna shall be mounted with base down for compliance with 3.10.4.

4.7.5 Sand and dust test. The unit(s) shall be subjected to Method 510.3 of MIL-STD-810 for compliance with 3.10.5.

4.7.6 Shock test. The unit(s) shall be subjected to the Equipment Crash-Safety Test in Method 516.4 of MIL-STD-810 for compliance with 3.10.6.

4.7.7 Acceleration. The unit(s) shall be tested in accordance with Method 5.13.4 of MIL-STD-810 for compliance with 3.10.7.

4.7.8 Salt fog. The unit(s) shall be exposed in its normal operating condition to salt fog in accordance with Method 509.3 of MIL-STD-810 for 48 hours. The unit(s) shall not be opened and shall not be required to be operated. The unit(s) shall meet the requirement of 3.10.8.

4.8 Electrical requirements.

4.8.1 Impedance, input/output. Under standard test conditions, mount the antenna on the 4 foot ground plane and measure the impedance. These measurements shall be made for compliance with 3.11.1.

4.8.2 Voltage standing wave ratio (VSWR). Under standard test conditions, mount the antenna on the 4 foot ground plane and measure the VSWR. These measurements shall be made for compliance with 3.11.2.

4.8.3 Omnidirectional pattern. Under standard test conditions, mount the antenna on the 4.0 foot diameter ground plane and measure the radiation pattern at the azimuth plane (parallel to level flight of aircraft). The azimuthal cut shall be measured at 90, 80 and 45 degrees. These measurements shall be made at the low, middle, and high frequencies of each band for compliance with 3.11.3.

4.8.4 Gain, antenna. The test procedure utilized for this test shall be that procedure submitted by the bidder with his proposal and approved by the Government. These approved tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with 3.11.4.

4.8.5 Isolation, bands. Under standard test conditions mount the antenna on the 4 foot ground plane and feed a VHF signal to the VHF connector and measure

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the resultant signal from the UHF connector, then feed a VHF signal to the UHF connector and measure the resultant signal from the VHF connector, (the cable loss shall be determined at each test frequency when recording the isolation between the feed connectors). These measurements shall be made at standard test frequencies to determine compliance with 3.11.5.

4.8.6 Power input, RF. Feed 50 watts of power to the antenna for a period of 10 minutes. The 50 watts shall be applied at three (3) frequencies at the low end, middle and upper end of each frequency band to determine compliance with 3.11.6.

4.9 Visual and mechanical. The assemblies, prior to assembly, and the complete assembled unit(s) shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-STD-252.

4.10 Interchanageability. The dimensions listed below shall be gaged or measured to determine compliance with the physical interchangeability requirements of 3.13. When a listed dimension is not within specified or design limits, it shall be considered a major defect:

a. External and internal dimensions of moldings, mounting base and insertable parts, when such dimensions affect mating.

b. Dimension of cavities, when such dimensions affect insertion of items.

c. Locations of holes on separable parts which must mate such as mounting assemblies.

d. Location of connectors, mounting base holes.

e. Size and form of threads.

4.11 Operational inspection. Each unit shall be inspected for assurance that the equipment is in operating condition prior to packaging.

4.12 System safety inspection. An inspection shall be performed to verify compliance with those portions of 3.16 which can be determined visually.

5. PACKING

5.1 Packing requirements. The packing requirements for the desired level(s) of protection shall be as specified by the acquisition activity (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The antenna AT-1108( )/ARC is intended to be used with VHF and/or UHF Radio Sets for communication when installed on either fixed or rotary wing aircraft.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

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a. Title, number, and date of this specification and any amendment thereto.

b. Level of preservation and packing (see section 5).

c. First article inspection. Two (2) sample units of each item cited in Section I are generally required so that lengthy environmental tests can be completed on one sample unit while complete performance measurements can be made on the second sample unit (see 3.1).

d. Marking and shipping of samples.

e. Place of final inspection.

f. Technical literature required (see 3.14).

g. Quality of tools.

h. Submission of the statement of treatment referenced in 3.9.5 should be sixty (60) days after award of contract. This statement should be submitted as indicated in the contract.

i. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1 and 2.2).

j. When first article is required (see 3.1).

6.3 Nomenclature. The parentheses in the nomenclature will be deleted or replaced by a letter identifying the particular design; for example: AT-1108W/ARC. The contractor should apply for nomenclature in accordance with the applicable clause in the contract.

6.4 Group C inspection. Approval to ship may be withheld, at the discretion of the Government, pending results of the corrective action specified in the contract.

6.5 Location of operational inspection. It is desirable that the operational inspection 4.11 be performed at a location that will minimize handling (which might cause damage to the units) after this inspection. It is recommended that the entire lot (including the sample units) be inspected immediately prior to packaging.

6.6 Verification inspection. Verification by the Government will be limited to the amount deemed necessary to determine compliance with the contract and will be limited in severity to the definitive Quality Assurance provisions established in this specification and the contract. The amount of verification inspection by the Government will be adjusted to make maximum utilization of the contractor's quality control system and the quality history of the product.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Radio communications, aircraft, fixed wing
Radio communications, aircraft, rotary wing
Radio sets, UHF, aircraft, fixed wing

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Radio sets, UHF, aircraft, rotary wing
Radio sets, VHF, aircraft, fixed wing
Radio sets, VHF, aircraft, rotary wing

6.8 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the items(s) should be a first article sample, a first production item, or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory and the number of items to be tested as specified in Section 4. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.9 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodian:
Army - CR

Preparing activity:
Army - CR
(Project 5821-A231)

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